



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 01

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Proper Lifting Techniques & Body Mechanics

OVERVIEW:

Back injuries from improper lifting are among the most common and costly injuries in millwork and carpentry. A single lift done wrong can result in weeks away from work or permanent spinal damage. Today we review how to lift safely every time, no matter what you are moving.

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Before you lift anything, stop and assess the load. Ask yourself: How heavy is this? Can I see over it? Is my path clear of trip hazards? If you cannot answer yes to all three, you are not ready to lift. Heavy lumber, sheet goods, and door units can weigh 60 to 150 pounds. Never assume you can handle it alone.
2. When you lift, position your feet shoulder-width apart with one foot slightly forward. Squat down to the load — bend at the knees, not the waist. Keep your back straight and your core braced tight. Then push up through your legs, keeping the load as close to your body as possible the entire time. Your legs are built for this. Your lower back is not.
3. Twisting while carrying a load is one of the leading causes of disc injuries on the job. If you need to change direction, move your feet — do not twist at the waist. Set the load down before turning if needed, re-grip, and then move. This takes five extra seconds and could save your back for life.
4. Team lifting requires clear communication before the lift begins. Agree on a signal — 'Ready, lift on three' — and make sure both workers are at the same height, gripping securely, and ready to move together. A dropped load can injure both workers. Never assume your partner is ready. Always confirm out loud.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Has anyone been hurt by a lifting injury or seen one happen on a job? What could have been done differently?
- Q2: What mechanical assists — dollies, panel carriers, hand trucks — do we have available on this site right now?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Never lift more than 50 lbs alone — use equipment or get help
- Inspect your path before carrying; clear all trip hazards first
- Wear gloves when handling rough lumber or sheet goods
- Set loads down carefully — pinch points cause hand and finger injuries
- Stretch before heavy lifting tasks, especially in cold weather

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 01

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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